

Christopher Klein - User Experience Designer

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User Experience Designer with 13 years shipping software titles through the full SDLC and post-release Live Operations. Skilled at translating technical and user friction into clear, actionable design solutions for engineers, artists, and stakeholders. Built the UX pipeline for Cloud Imperium Games' internal editor tools from the ground up, and led QA strategy for large-scale playtests at Intrepid Studios.

Core Skills

Development processes and tools

- User-Centered Design & Research: heuristic evaluation (Nielsen Norman heuristics), user surveys, qualitative interviews, user journey mapping, large-scale playtest synthesis (200+ concurrent users), translating stakeholder and end-user friction into structured design findings.
- WCAG Accessibility testing and verification on personal site using Playwright, Axe-Core, manual keyboard focus pathing, NVDA screen reader, and WAVE Extension.
- Front-End: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript — design and maintenance of personal site.
- Design & Prototyping Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, XD.
- Stakeholder Communication & Facilitation: leadership presentations, cross-vendor onboarding, triage meeting representation, Go/No-Go recommendation reporting.
- Documentation & Plain Language: SOPs, workflow guides, structured findings reports

Experience

INTREPID STUDIOS, INC

Senior Quality Analyst | "Ashes of Creation", Systems Team | 07/14/2024 – 02/01/2026

- Designed and executed comprehensive test plans for 10+ core gameplay systems, focused on mitigating critical launch risks during release cycles.
- Owned onboarding for 3 successive external QA vendor teams, designing SOPs and training programs on internal tools, features, and technical processes, reducing ramp time with each transition.
- Engineered custom Jira dashboards with QA team providing real-time visibility into feature progress and defect density, enabling leadership to make data-driven Go/No-Go release decisions.
- Optimized internal QA tools, significantly reducing scenario setup time and increasing overall test execution efficiency.

CLOUD IMPERIUM GAMES, LLC

User Experience Designer | "Star Engine", Editor Team | 01/01/2021 – 10/01/2023

- Built a UX pipeline for engine tools, translating user friction and technical issues from engineers, artists, and designers into structured findings for stakeholders.
- Refined user journeys and mapped user feedback to them using Miro.
- Created wireframes and icons for legacy tool updates and new tool designs in Figma.
- Collaborated with embedded QA to develop new test cases and automation coverage for the Editor.
- Created and maintained centralized technical documentation for development tools, reducing time-to-competency for new and senior developers.

Senior Quality Assurance Tester | "Star Citizen", Vehicle Team | 02/14/2018 – 12/01/2020

- Developed global QA strategies for vehicle and level testing on Star Citizen's Persistent Universe, improving cross-departmental testing efficiency.
- Ran local and remote playtests for new vehicles and features, gathering insights and metrics ahead of minor and major milestones.
- Developed global QA strategies for vehicle and level testing on Star Citizen's Persistent Universe, improving cross-departmental testing efficiency.
- Acted as de facto lead in manager's absence: represented the team in Lead Triage meetings and contributed to feature strategy discussions for upcoming vehicle content.
- Trained 3 new testers to full production readiness through structured performance reviews and technical workshops.

PHOSPHOR GAMES, LLC

QA Lead | "Jurassic World", "Batman VRSE", "Brookhaven Experiment" | 01/01/2017 – 08/01/2017

- Directed internal testing and certification across multiple VR platforms and mobile environments (TRC, XR, iOS, Android).
- Pitched and led the studio's migration off Hansoft, replacing it with TestRail for QA and Jira for production and development - improving traceability, Perforce integration, and per-team task visibility. Onboarded the full team to the new pipeline.
- Hired and managed a 4-person QA team across 3 shipped titles, owning the full hiring, training, and professional development lifecycle.

WARGAMING.NET

Quality Assurance Tester | "World of Tanks" (Xbox/PS4) | 08/01/2014 – 10/01/2016

- Streamlined daily smoke testing, enabling rapid build distribution across all console platforms for the department.
- Mastered diverse game modules through rotation, ensuring high-level domain expertise and consistent player experience across the title.

PHOSPHOR GAMES, LLC

QA Tester | "Nether", "WARP" | 10/01/2013 – 08/01/2014

- Executed ad-hoc and regression testing in Unreal Engine 3, identifying high-priority defects within a rapid-iteration small team environment.
- Ensured production environment reliability by verifying build consistency and documenting malfunctions for immediate developer resolution.

Education

DePaul University, Chicago, IL

Bachelor's Degree, Game Development, 2013